

PS Vita: Is it worth it?

Launched last month, everyone's raving about Sony's new handheld console. Should you?
<http://bit.ly/yCOuTp>

Ubuntu on Android

A dual-OS concept allows smartphone to be docked and used as a desktop
<http://bit.ly/zcyeVb>

Laptop Comparison

performance in much detail here, just a few important highlights that couldn't find its way into the table on the next stage.

We would like to point out that the Apple MacBook Pro had by far the best screen among all



Acer Aspire 5755G

the laptops we tested in terms of image and text sharpness, viewing angles, colour consistency, brightness and contrast. Next in line were the Sony VAIO C, Lenovo IdeaPad Y570, HP Pavilion dv6, and Dell XPS 14z with varying degrees of screen quality – all good though.

The only laptops you can use to get away with playing the latest games without being utterly disappointed are the HP Pavilion dv6, Lenovo IdeaPad Y570, MSI GE620, Acer Aspire 5755G and the Acer Aspire TimelineX 5830TG laptops. The laptop with the most battery backup was the Asus U32U which easily sailed past the 4 hour mark on our battery benchmark, primarily because it's based on AMD's Brazos APU, the E-450, which is a low-powered chip compared to the Intel Core processors, low in performance but great for conserving battery power.

Winners

Out of the 15 laptops contesting in this category, the Best Buy

award goes to the Toshiba Satellite L750-P5210, while the Editor's Pick is conferred upon the HP Pavilion dv6-6121tx. The Toshiba Satellite really did well in all departments, despite being a budget laptop running on an older processor. It's recommended for someone interested in a basic computer for household needs without over-extending one's budget.

The HP Pavilion dv6, on the other hand, is a premium home entertainment laptop which does very well in every department – features, performance, design and usability – and fully justifies its price tag. Hence, it's our Editor's Pick for this month.

It's recommended for anyone who wants a premium, good-looking, 15-inch, all purpose laptop for home entertainment and a bit of gaming.

Other honourable mentions include the Sony VAIO C, Dell XPS 14z, Lenovo IdeaPad Y570 and the Acer Aspire TimelineX 5830TG – all very good laptops to buy if you have certain brand preferences that can't be changed.

Overall, we learned that almost every laptop manufacturer is pulling their socks up to offer laptops with unique value propositions to make them more attractive to buyers.

Ultrabooks

Yes, they are the sleek, sexy, thin but powerful new-age variety of laptops we discussed briefly in the introduction of this article. Intel has gone on record to state that 40% of laptops launched this year will be ultrabooks, that manufacturers will flood the market with over 70 different types of ultrabook offerings globally. Such a remark from

someone who makes chips that goes into hundreds of thousands of laptops every year is definitely a sign of things to come. For better or worse, the ultrabook is the next big wave on the laptop horizon – if you think it's for the worst, stay happy in your smartphone and tablet camp.

Technically, we only received four ultrabooks from four manufacturers – Acer, Asus, Dell, HP, and Lenovo – but we figured since all of them are targeting Apple's MacBook Air, we would group the 11-inch Air in the ultrabook club to give you a better per-



Apple MacBook Pro 13-inch

spective on where things stand as of now.

Also, it's considerably easier to compare each of these ultrabooks with the Air, spec to spec, feature to feature, when they're packed next to each other in the comparison table.

Build and Design

Although Intel has an established roadmap with respect to the processor architecture, the

defining physical attributes for an ultrabook are still largely its slimmer, thinner dimensions. The Acer Aspire S3 and Lenovo IdeaPad U300s are less than 0.7-inch in thickness, while the Asus Zenbook UX31E and HP Folio 13 are slightly thicker than 0.7-inches, but still slimmer than 1-inch, when measured with their lid closed. None of

the bundled laptops weigh more than 1.5 kg, which is the weight of the "heaviest" ultrabook – the HP Folio 13.

All four ultrabooks in the comparison sport metal screen lids, with two sporting an all-metal exterior (Asus, Lenovo) while the other two having to make do with reinforced plastic shells (Acer, HP).

While the Lenovo and Acer ultrabooks have smooth metal



Acer Aspire S3